MINUTES OF THE INTERNATIONAL COMPARISON PROGRAM

INTER-AGENCY COORDINATION GROUP MEETING

OCTOBER 20 – 24, 2025

MC C2-370, WORLD BANK HQ, WASHINGTON, DC

Welcome and meeting objectives

A meeting of the International Comparison Program (ICP) Inter-Agency Coordination Group (IACG) was held from October 20 to 24, 2025, in a hybrid mode (in person and virtual) in Washington, DC, at the World Bank headquarters.

The main objectives of the meeting were: (i) review the implementation status of the ICP 2024 cycle; (ii) discuss findings from the ICP 2024 cycle validation; (iii) review the operational procedures and materials for computation and data submission; (iv) review the progress of modernization efforts in ICP activities and tools; (v) plan and strategize the ICP global communication strategies; (vi) plan and strategize Task Force activities for annual PPP production and ICP classification; (vii) plan upcoming ICP governance and coordination activities.

Haishan Fu, World Bank, welcomed the attendees and delivered opening remarks, noting that October 20 coincided with World Statistics Day, providing an auspicious start for the meeting. Following a round of introductions, she reflected on the legacy of the late Professor Alan Heston and on how the International Comparison Program (ICP) has evolved from an academic research initiative into one of the world's largest statistical programs. She acknowledged the contributions of all ICP implementing agencies to the successful completion of the 2021 cycle and to the expanding uses of purchasing power parities (PPPs). Looking ahead, she highlighted the inclusion of Pacific Island countries in the ICP 2024 cycle and emphasized the importance of the work of the ICP Annual PPP and Classification Task Forces in supporting the transition toward annual PPP production while ensuring alignment with evolving international standards, including SNA 2025 and COICOP 2018. She further underscored the importance of the ICP exploring opportunities to modernize data collection and production processes, including through the potential use of new technologies such as artificial intelligence and alternative data sources.

The meeting participants are listed in Annex 2. In addition, the meeting agenda and public presentations are available here.

D1.00 - Introduction of the Development Economics Data Group Survey Unit

Talip Kilic, World Bank, informed participants that the ICP Global Office is now part of the newly established Survey Unit within the World Bank's Development Economics Data Group, alongside the Living Standards Measurement Study (LSMS) and Survey Solutions teams. This organizational change, which formally took effect on July 1, 2025, following preparatory work that began in March 2025, aims to strengthen coordination and synergies across the World Bank's major survey and data programs. In his role as Acting Manager of the Survey Unit, Kilic has been working closely with the ICP team to gain a comprehensive understanding of its current operations and future directions, while emphasizing the importance of leveraging the combined technical capacities of the ICP, LSMS, Survey Solutions, and other resources within the Development Data Group. This new unit structure was presented as a strategic platform to support continued innovation in price data collection, purchasing power parity (PPP) estimation, and the broader modernization of the ICP program.

Kilic outlined four main priorities for the newly consolidated Survey Unit. First, he emphasized the importance of strengthening internal synergies—not only across the three core programs, but also with other technical capabilities within the department—to enhance the effectiveness and impact of ICP delivery. Second, he highlighted partnerships and resource mobilization as critical priorities, noting that the sustainability of the ICP, particularly at the regional level, depends on securing sustained support from key partners and donors. In this context, he referred to ongoing engagement efforts with a range of organizations aimed at supporting regional implementation and facilitating a transition toward more frequent, ideally annual, PPP production. Third, Kilic underscored the role of methodological research and innovation, stressing the need for a more formalized process to review, deliberate, and implement methodological changes so that research activities are closely aligned with, and directly inform, operational improvements. Finally, he emphasized the importance of strategic communications at both the global and regional levels to strengthen the positioning of the ICP as a global public good and to foster more effective engagement with regional partners and stakeholders.

Throughout his remarks, Kilic emphasized the importance of drawing on the experience of the ICP community and of continued collaboration across partners and regions. He acknowledged the central role of partnerships and regional support in the implementation of the ICP and described the new Survey Unit as a practical organizational platform for supporting the program's ongoing modernization, long-term sustainability, and effective delivery of global price statistics and PPP estimates.

D1.01 - Global updates

Marko Rissanen, World Bank, presented global updates on the implementation of the ICP 2024 cycle, governance and coordination arrangements, outreach activities, and recent uses of PPPs.

<u>ICP 2024 cycle implementation</u>

Implementation of the ICP 2024 cycle is ongoing across all regions, with the objective of achieving broader country coverage than in previous cycles, including the return of Pacific Island economies as participants. Regional datasets for global validation are expected to be submitted on a rolling, quarterly basis throughout 2026, enabling continuous validation and feedback and supporting a more iterative and responsive production process. The cycle also places emphasis on greater harmonization of definitions and operational materials, as well as on the use of digital solutions—such as Survey Solutions and cloud- and SDMX-based tools—to support the modernization of data collection and processing. At the same time, several risks remain for the current cycle, notably those related to financial sustainability, operational capacity constraints faced by smaller national statistical offices, and uncertainties around country participation arising from geopolitical developments. In parallel, donor engagement intensified during 2025, with outreach undertaken across bilateral, multilateral, and philanthropic channels, encompassing a wide range of institutions and financing mechanisms. These resource mobilization efforts are being closely aligned with the Program's broader modernization agenda, with the aim of supporting timely, policy-relevant, and sustainable production of PPPs.

Governance and coordination activities

The 56th Session of the United Nations Statistical Commission (UNSC) took place from March 4 to 7, 2025. The Commission was informed of the release of the 2021 ICP cycle results, progress in the implementation of the 2024 ICP cycle, the uses of the PPPs produced by the Program, and related risks—particularly those associated with available resources—along with corresponding mitigation measures. The upcoming 57th Session of the UNSC was also highlighted, with inputs from the Regional Implementing Agencies (RIAs) on regional progress due by 31 October 2025, which will be critical for the preparation of the Commission report.

The 2025 ICP Governing Board meeting, held in March 2025, marked the final meeting under the current Board composition. The Board reviewed the completion of the ICP 2021 cycle, including the release of global and regional results, methodological improvements, and expanded country participation, and discussed progress and key risks related to the 2024 cycle. Preparations are under way for the establishment of a new ICP Governing Board, with nominations solicited from all ICP regions for the next set of national representatives. This process includes the issuance of formal invitations and confirmation of acceptance, with the objective of convening the first meeting of the new Governing Board alongside the 57th Session of the UNSC in March 2026.

It was further noted that the Technical Advisory Group (TAG) met in March 2025 to discuss issues arising from recent ICP cycles, as well as short- and long-term research topics. The Group reviewed future research priorities and emphasized the need to develop a new research agenda that reflects emerging methodological challenges and an evolving data environment. Following the TAG's endorsement, two new research task forces are being launched: one on Annual PPP Production and another on ICP Classification Updates. Emphasis was also placed on the importance of timely communication and careful logistical planning for all governance meetings, particularly in light of ongoing travel and funding constraints.

Outreach initiatives

The ICP continues to be represented at global events, including World Statistics Day, the UNSC side event "Carrying Forward the Legacy of the ICP," and a range of regional conferences and workshops. Efforts to support the use of purchasing power parities (PPPs) have included the dissemination of technical papers, the organization of side events, and the release of a promotional video, as reflected in the growing range of documented PPP applications. In parallel, communication approaches are being reviewed with the aim of strengthening the visibility and effective use of ICP outputs, including improved tracking of PPP usage in policy and research contexts. To support this work, AI-enabled tools are being piloted to help identify, categorize, and report on the use of ICP data and PPPs across organizations and publications.

Recent PPP uses

Recent applications of PPPs illustrate their continued role in global analytical and policy frameworks. The World Bank has adopted the 2021 PPPs for the international poverty line, revising it to $3.00 per day and incorporating updated national poverty lines and household survey data. The International Monetary Fund's World Economic Outlook now applies the 2021 PPPs in its economic analysis and projections, while the Human Development Index and a range of energy, climate, and defense expenditure reports use PPPs to support cross-country comparisons. PPPs also underpin key indicators in the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations' State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World report and are being considered in discussions on updating income classifications. The ICP team continues to systematically document and monitor these uses as part of its efforts to assess the reach and application of PPPs across global statistical and analytical products.

D1.02 - Regional updates

Africa

Grégoire Mboya de Loubassou, African Development Bank (AfDB), presented an update on the implementation of the ICP 2024 cycle and forthcoming activities in the Africa region. In October 2025, AfDB published a regional report entitled *Purchasing Power Parities and the Real Sizes of African Economies – Highlights from the 2021 International Comparison Program for Africa*, which presents key findings for 52 African economies. Participation of 52 economies in the ICP 2024 cycle has been confirmed, while re-engagement efforts continue with Eritrea and Libya. Libya has made progress toward participation, whereas Eritrea continues to face staffing constraints.

Data collection is actively underway across the region; however, implementation has been affected by resource constraints and funding cycles, which have resulted in overlaps between the 2021 and 2024 ICP cycles. To address these challenges, the region has adopted a cooperative and pragmatic approach, including greater use of ICP–CPI common items and, where necessary, extrapolation from previous cycles. Special surveys covering education, government, housing rents, and machinery are in progress, although some countries are experiencing delays due to administrative and capacity limitations.

Recent and planned activities include regional validation workshops, with a major session expected following the next resource replenishment in 2026. Bilateral reviews and validation exercises are continuing as countries submit data, alongside ongoing collaboration with partners such as UN-Habitat to support technical assistance and validation.

Additional updates highlighted the need to adapt to rapid changes in product markets, including the increasing prevalence of Chinese vehicle models, as well as ongoing efforts to harmonize GDP rebasing and expenditure data and to manage multiple currencies in selected countries. Country-specific administrative procedures, notably in Algeria and Morocco, were noted as adding further complexity to implementation. The region is also advancing work on strengthening ICP–CPI integration and stabilizing item lists.

Key challenges identified include staff turnover, resource constraints, and the need to align with updated international classifications, including COICOP 2018 and forthcoming revisions. Delays in funding and administrative approvals continue to pose implementation risks, alongside the need for more stable and representative item lists and deeper integration between ICP and CPI processes.

Asia and the Pacific

Kaushal Joshi, Asian Development Bank (ADB), presented an update on the implementation of the ICP 2024 cycle and forthcoming activities in the Asia and Pacific region. In September 2025, ADB published the Economy Profiles, which present key statistics on ICP results and implementation, including detailed country-level data and insights into national experiences with the Program. ICP data were also featured during ADB's World Statistics Day Data Festival. ADB will also release a publication on the ICP in Asia and Pacific region in the global context as a special supplement to its annual flagship publication Key Indicators for Asia and the Pacific in December 2025[1].

The ICP 2024 cycle in Asia and the Pacific involves 22 participating economies, with Timor-Leste joining as a new participant. Operational materials and data management tools, including the Asia Pacific Software Suite (APSS) and computer-assisted personal interviewing (CAPI) systems, have been updated to support ICP 2024 activities.

[1] https://www.adb.org/publications/key-indicators-2025-special-supplement

With respect to data collection, most economies have initiated or completed surveys covering household consumption, construction, machinery, housing rents, and government compensation. A small number of countries—including Thailand, Lao PDR, and Timor-Leste—are experiencing delays in survey implementation but are receiving targeted technical support. Accordingly, survey schedule has been extended until December 2025, to enable full participation of all 22 economies. Prices collected outside the reference year 2024 will be backcasted to the 2024 reference year. The region expects to finalize the data and results for 2024 ICP by the end of 2026 and publish the results by Q1 of 2027.

Price data for all ICP surveys is being submitted regularly by all participating economies and ADB has continuously engaged with them for intra- and inter-economy price validation to identify price outliers and to address data quality issues. Several regional workshops in hybrid mode have already been conducted to support data validation, with additional sessions planned for December 2025 and the first quarter of 2026. The region is also placing increased emphasis on metadata compilation and documentation to support institutional continuity in the context of frequent staff turnover. Capacity-building activities include sessions on the transition to COICOP 2018, the development of annual PPPs, and the integration of CPI and ICP processes. Best practices, such as Singapore's experience with CPI–ICP integration, are being shared across the region, alongside continued experimentation with digital tools.

Key challenges faced in the region include administrative delays in a few participating economies often linked to government internal processes, staff resource constraints, and competing demands from other national statistical activities. However, these have been managed through active support by ADB to minimize impact on the survey schedule. Ensuring consistent data quality across diverse country contexts and managing the transition toward more frequent, including annual, PPP production remain ongoing considerations.

Commonwealth of Independent States

Andrey Kosarev, Interstate Statistical Committee of the Commonwealth of Independent States (CIS-STAT), presented an update on the implementation of the ICP 2024 cycle and forthcoming activities in the CIS region.

The CIS region, coordinated by CIS-STAT, comprises eight economies participating in the ICP 2024 cycle: Armenia, Azerbaijan, Belarus, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Russia, Tajikistan, and Uzbekistan. Moldova is participating through Eurostat, while Turkmenistan is not fully engaged in the current cycle. All participating economies have completed 2024 data collection for household consumption, machinery, and construction, and validation activities are ongoing, characterized by broad item coverage and iterative quality improvements.

Recent regional meetings in Minsk and Astana focused on the validation of machinery, equipment, and consumer price data. Upcoming meetings in Moscow and Tashkent will address CPI–ICP integration and implementation of SNA 2025, with a further regional coordination and validation meeting planned for June 2026.

A notable feature of the CIS implementation is the use of a large and detailed consumption item list, exceeding 2,000 items. While data collection has proceeded smoothly, harmonization and validation remain resource-intensive. CIS-STAT continues to align regional practices with global ICP standards and classifications, while adapting to staffing changes at national statistical offices. Participating economies have further advanced ICP–CPI integration, including the use of CPI prices and, in some cases, scanner data.

Key challenges include harmonizing specifications across diverse economies, managing resource constraints, and ensuring timely data submission and validation, as well as integrating updated classifications and methodologies under the global ICP framework.

As a final update, it was noted that the 3rd CIS International Statistical Forum, *"Prospects of Statistics: International Projects,"* was held in Baku, Azerbaijan, from September 24 to 26, 2025. The ICP 2024 cycle was featured as one of the key topics of the Forum, which brought together more than 240 participants from CIS countries and other regions, including representatives of national statistical offices, international organizations, public authorities, and academia.

Eurostat–Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD) PPP Programme

Hakam Jayyousi, Eurostat, and Sophie Bournot, Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD), presented an update on the implementation of the ICP 2024 cycle and forthcoming activities under the Eurostat–OECD PPP Programme.

The Eurostat-OECD PPP Programme covers 49 economies, including European Union (EU) and European Free Trade Association (EFTA) members, EU candidate countries, and other OECD economies. The Programme conducts regular rolling surveys covering consumer goods and services, construction, equipment, and special topics, and is currently implementing the Classification of Individual Consumption According to Purpose (COICOP) 2018 for PPP purposes, including the recalculation of historical survey data to ensure consistency with the updated classification. The United Kingdom is rejoining the Eurostat Programme, and additional countries, such as Peru, are expected to participate in OECD calculations.

Eurostat organizes two country meetings per year for each survey, while joint Eurostat–OECD workshops are held biennially, with a focus on emerging data sources, web scraping, and methodological developments. Upcoming activities include dedicated sessions to review progress on the implementation of COICOP 2018 and the annual PPP Working Group meeting scheduled for November.

Key developments in the region include the expanding use of scanner data and web-scraped prices, accompanied by ongoing methodological work and regulatory adjustments to facilitate data access. The Programme is also updating methodological manuals and IT tools for data collection and validation, and is working toward greater harmonization of survey calendars and integration of new classifications.

Challenges identified include the alignment of survey schedules, the integration of updated classifications, and the management of data validation timelines. Staff turnover and resource constraints continue to affect the pace of IT tool development and innovation, alongside the need for more harmonized approaches to the use of scanner data and web scraping across participating economies.

Latin America and the Caribbean

Rolando Ocampo, United Nations Economic Commission for Latin America and the Caribbean (UN-ECLAC), presented an update on the implementation of the ICP 2024 cycle and forthcoming activities in the Latin America and the Caribbean region.

In Latin America and the Caribbean, 35 economies are participating in the ICP 2024 cycle, although some—particularly in the Caribbean—are experiencing delays in data submission. Data collection is under way for household consumption, education, government, construction, and machinery surveys, with coverage varying across countries and survey components. The region is actively engaged in inter-country validation activities, with a strong emphasis on improving data quality and completeness.

A regional validation meeting on household consumption was held in July 2025, and the next workshop focusing on special surveys is scheduled for December 2025. In parallel, bilateral technical meetings with national statistical offices are ongoing to provide targeted support and follow-up. The region also continues to participate in workshops and presentations at regional statistical conferences and meetings of national statistical institutes.

Key developments include the incorporation of ICP results into statistical yearbooks and online dissemination platforms, continued efforts to strengthen the alignment of CPI and ICP processes, and the development of new tools to support future ICP cycles. Capacity building, methodological harmonization, and documentation remain central priorities in addressing regional implementation challenges.

UN-ECLAC highlighted a number of persistent challenges, including resource constraints, staff turnover, and administrative changes at the national level. There is a particular need for additional technical assistance in complex survey areas, such as machinery and equipment, as well as for increased in-person engagement to support countries with more limited implementation capacity.

Western Asia

Majed Skaini, United Nations Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia (UN-ESCWA), presented an update on the implementation of the ICP 2024 cycle and forthcoming activities in the Western Asia region.

Sixteen Arab economies are participating in the ICP 2024 cycle. Annual data collection for household consumption and selected special surveys is ongoing, with the region piloting digital tools such as the Data Entry Tool (DET) to support data entry and validation, as well as exploring the use of web scraping for price collection.

For the 2021 cycle, UN-ESCWA published its regional report in March 2025, entitled *The Real Size of Arab Economies, 2017–2023*, which provides a comprehensive analysis of the 2021 ICP results and purchasing power parity (PPP) data for the region over the period 2017–2023.

For the ICP 2024 cycle, all participating economies submitted price data for household consumption and special surveys by mid-2025, and a Regional Inter-Country Validation Meeting was held in Amman in September–October 2025. In parallel, both online and in-person training sessions have been conducted for national teams on the use of new tools and validation procedures. Additional online sessions are planned to support further validation and data revision, alongside continued capacity-building activities.

Key developments include a strong emphasis on digital modernization and capacity building, particularly through the piloting of modern new tools for price data collection, validation and PPP production. The region is also exploring the integration of technology, data science, and AI into price statistics operations, while maintaining close engagement with national teams in the context of staff turnover and resource constraints.

The region continues to face challenges related to staff turnover, funding limitations, and political instability in some economies. Sustained technical assistance and predictable financing remain critical to supporting implementation, and the feasibility of maintaining annual PPP production without additional resources was identified as an ongoing concern.

Pacific Islands

Rui Costa, World Bank, on behalf of the Pacific Community (SPC), presented an update on the implementation of the ICP 2024 cycle and forthcoming activities in the Pacific Islands region.

The Pacific Community is coordinating the participation of 16 Pacific Island economies in the ICP 2024 cycle, marking their return to the Program following their participation in the 2011 cycle. Data collection for household consumption is under way, supported by updated regional item lists aligned with global ICP standards. The SPC, the ICP Global Office, and the World Bank's Survey Solutions team have collaborated in the design of a tailored computer-assisted personal interviewing (CAPI) questionnaire and associated data collection workflows.

A regional workshop was held in Nadi, Fiji, in June 2025 to introduce the ICP and train national teams. Two additional regional workshops are planned for 2026, focusing respectively on price data validation and on national accounts work and planning for subsequent ICP cycles.

Key developments include positive feedback on the use of digital tools and strong regional cooperation, as well as ongoing efforts to expand data collection to additional components, including housing rentals and government compensation. The region is also benefiting from the involvement of former national coordinators who have joined the SPC team, strengthening technical capacity and institutional continuity.

The Pacific Islands region faces specific challenges related to small population sizes, geographic remoteness, and limited resources. At the same time, high levels of engagement and a strong interest in digital solutions and regional collaboration were noted as important factors supporting the region's re-engagement with the ICP.

D2.01 - Regional validation findings and recommendations

Rui Costa, World Bank, presented the session on regional validation findings, with a focus on improving the ICP global item lists by drawing on practical experiences and feedback from the Regional Implementing Agencies (RIAs).

The session emphasized that systematic collection and analysis of feedback from price data collection are essential for refining global item lists in future cycles, to ensure that items remain both relevant and internationally comparable. While items should reflect actual consumption patterns within countries and regions, they must also be comparable across economies to serve the objectives of the ICP. Items that are not comparable provide limited analytical value, regardless of their local representativeness. Particular challenges were noted for services, where quality differences are often subjective and difficult to standardize across countries. The discussion also highlighted the rapid evolution of technology-related products and motor vehicles, underscoring the need for more frequent updates to item lists to keep pace with market developments. In addition, several regions reported limited technical capacity for validating and expanding machinery and equipment lists, pointing to the need for greater support from the Global Office, including research inputs and, where appropriate, external expertise.

Regional practices and recommendations were shared to illustrate how these challenges are being addressed. In the Asia and Pacific region, indicative models have been selected for unspecified machinery items whose specifications are very close to their specified counterparts to improve regional comparability. Region's economies have called for an earlier dissemination of item lists for the 2027 ICP cycle and more regionally appropriate specifications. Many economies experienced non-availability of specified models of fastmoving electronic items in the product list due to obsolescence. The region also emphasized better integration of construction and rental surveys conducted by the economies into the ICP process. In Africa, participants advocated for a bottom-up approach, starting from regional item lists derived from CPI baskets and introducing global core items as needed, to ensure both representativeness and comparability at the regional level. It was noted, however, that many common regional items are already reflected in the global core list, and that updates to both regional and global lists should follow an iterative and collaborative process.

Latin America and the Caribbean described the use of bilateral consultations and dashboard tools to support validation and issue identification, reiterating the need for technical assistance in machinery and equipment validation and for multi-round, iterative validation processes. The Eurostat–OECD Programme highlighted its experience in implementing new classifications, including COICOP 2018, and in integrating scanner and web-scraped data into price collection, while noting ongoing challenges in ensuring that the level of item detail remains appropriate for both regional and global comparisons. The CIS region committed to providing an analysis of successfully priced global and regional items, with recommendations for additions or removals based on field experience. Western Asia reported on efforts to develop regionally specified versions of globally unspecified machinery and equipment items to improve comparability and suggested sharing these specifications across regions for potential adoption.

Several cross-cutting suggestions for improvement were identified. Participants noted the need to expand underrepresented basic headings, where limited item coverage can increase sensitivity to outliers, while also reviewing basic headings with extensive item lists priced by only a few economies. Revisiting the number of items per basic heading was highlighted as particularly important in light of the transition to COICOP 2018. Additional recommendations included clarifying and updating specifications for construction, developing more detailed guidance for pricing services and housing rentals—including treatment of furnished versus unfurnished units and integration of owner-occupied housing—and updating occupation lists and calculation guidance for government compensation, including leave entitlements and related adjustments.

The discussion concluded with agreement on next steps. Regions were encouraged to systematically document validation findings and proposed improvements during the current cycle for incorporation into the next revision of the global item lists. The ICP Global Office was invited to play a coordinating role in supporting regions, particularly in technically demanding areas such as machinery and equipment, and to facilitate the sharing of regional innovations and good practices across the Program.

D2.02 - Reference PPP Mapping

Giovanni Tonutti, World Bank, presented an overview of the ICP approach to estimating reference PPPs in cases where price data are not collected, highlighting the importance of these basic headings for achieving comprehensive GDP-level PPP estimates and outlining the computational steps used to derive PPPs for missing components. He then reviewed the current reference mapping, noting that there are no changes between the ICP 2021 and ICP 2024 cycles, and emphasized the importance of maintaining alignment between regional and global reference mappings.

During the discussion, it was noted that the use of reference PPPs represents one of several approaches to addressing unavailable price data, with reference made to the operational guidelines developed during the ICP 2011 cycle, which provide a comprehensive treatment of this issue. The representative from the Asia and Pacific region noted that, while the regional referencing mapping is aligned with the global mapping for most basic headings, the reference mapping for a few basic headings differ from the global approach to accommodate regional specificities. It was agreed that the computational tools used for regional PPP estimation would be reviewed and that any deviations in reference PPP mappings would be formally communicated to the ICP Global Office.

D2.03 - Item Mapping

Mizuki Yamanaka and Rui Costa, World Bank, presented an overview of the current ICP item mapping. The presenters explained that while most items are uniquely assigned to a single basic heading, there are important exceptions—particularly in the government compensation and construction surveys—where a single item may be relevant to multiple basic headings.

For government compensation, the session reviewed the ICP approach, which involves collecting salary data for a standardized set of occupations to estimate PPPs for public health, education, and collective services. The current cycle covers 35 occupations, some of which are mapped to more than one basic heading. For example, the occupation “building caretaker” contributes to the estimation of PPPs for health, education, and collective services. The presenters emphasized the importance of correctly duplicating such items in the mapping process and clarified that, while only one entry is required in the data submission form, the necessary duplication will be applied by the Global Office for global calculations. They also noted that regional calculations must ensure that these items are included in all relevant basic headings. The representative from the Asia and Pacific region noted the importance of validating the information on number of hours worked per week, number of public holidays, and number of paid annual leave, which are inputs in deriving the standard number of work hours for cross economy comparison of compensation. The experience from the region has suggested that participating economies may interpret these terms differently which has an impact on comparing government compensation.

In the case of construction and civil engineering, the mapping process is more complex due to the wide range of materials, equipment, and labor inputs used across different types of construction, including residential, non-residential, and civil engineering works. The ICP 2024 construction survey includes 59 items, of which only a subset is applicable to each construction type. The mapping is based on an indicative list specifying the items typically used for each category, as reflected in the operational guidelines and survey instruments. It was also noted that prices for electrical products used as construction materials are linked to the PPPs of the “electrical and optical equipment” basic heading.

The presenters encouraged regions to closely follow the mapping documentation and to communicate any ambiguities or region-specific requirements to the Global Office. They further emphasized that continued feedback from regions is essential for refining the mapping process and ensuring that it remains fit for purpose as methodologies and classifications continue to evolve.

D2.04 - PPP aggregation mapping

Giovanni Tonutti, World Bank, introduced the topic of PPP aggregation, reviewing the current ICP aggregation and mapping framework used for the estimation of GDP PPPs and their subcomponents. He explained that the current approach distinguishes between the hierarchical GDP structure and a set of 12 non-hierarchical analytical headings. No changes to the ICP classification are being introduced for the ICP 2024 cycle; however, the adoption of a new classification aligned with COICOP 2018 is expected to lead to more substantive restructuring beginning with the next cycle.

In this context, the ICP Global Office presented a proposal to expand the set of published non-hierarchical analytical headings to include PPPs for goods and services, as well as PPPs for public sector wages and construction wages, for internal analytical use. All four proposed aggregates would be derived from existing basic headings and would not require the collection of additional data, instead providing alternative aggregations of already available information.

During the discussion, it was agreed to extend the current classification to include the four proposed new analytical headings, with the option of also including PPPs for wages related to household domestic services. The Global Office will provide the updated aggregation mapping through the revised ICP 2024 data submission form.

D2.05 – Review of Survey, Metadata, and Submission Forms

The ICP Global Office provided an update on the data and metadata requirements for the ICP 2024 cycle, including the data collection and submission forms made available to the Regional Implementing Agencies (RIAs). For all special surveys, standardized data collection forms have been prepared to facilitate the collection of prices and their conversion into the required reporting units.

A proposal to reduce the volume of data required for the housing volume survey was discussed, drawing on feedback from national and regional agencies and a review of submissions from previous ICP cycles. It was agreed that reducing the number of items and clarifying definitions—such as those related to formal and informal dwellings—would improve the usability of the survey instrument. However, it was also agreed to retain the current housing volume survey form for the ICP 2024 cycle, with revisions to be considered for a subsequent cycle.

The data submission form was then presented, with clarification that no changes have been made to the file structure for the ICP 2024 cycle. Particular attention was drawn to the instructions sheet, which provides detailed guidance on data collection and reporting requirements.

The presenters next reviewed the metadata submission requirements. For ICP 2024, these remain unchanged, and national implementing agencies are requested to complete three metadata questionnaires: the Survey Framework Questionnaire, the National Accounts Country Practices Questionnaire, and the Housing Volume Questionnaire. The importance of the Survey Framework Questionnaire was emphasized, as it underpins the credibility and interpretability of ICP results and is of particular relevance to data users. Key metadata elements of interest include the geographic coverage of priced products, the types of outlets and markets surveyed, and whether items collected overlap with CPI surveys. The main change to this questionnaire is the removal of COVID-19–related questions that were introduced for the ICP 2021 cycle.

With respect to the National Accounts metadata questionnaire, the addition of an option for SNA 2025 to the question on the SNA version implemented was proposed, along with an additional field asking when countries expect to adopt the SNA 2025 framework. It was clarified that this information is intended for informational purposes only. No changes were proposed for the housing metadata questionnaire for the current cycle.

During the discussion, representatives from RIAs welcomed the proposal to remove the distinction between formal and informal housing, noting that such information is often difficult to obtain and does not materially affect the measurement of housing availability in many countries. It was also observed that relatively few countries are expected to begin implementing the SNA 2025 framework during the ICP 2024 cycle, with broader adoption anticipated closer to 2030. In this context, it was suggested that the inclusion of SNA 2025–related questions may be more appropriately deferred to the next ICP cycle. Asia Pacific regional representative informed that the question on SNA 2025 has already been included in the regional metadata questionnaire and will be maintained for region's reference purposes.

D2.06 – Increasing transparency of global PPP calculation procedures

Giovanni Tonutti, World Bank, presented past and ongoing efforts to increase the transparency of global PPP computational procedures. A draft comprehensive compendium of the ICP 2021 methodology was discussed, with the objective of providing a single reference document for methodological inquiries, documenting the steps involved in the production of the 2021 benchmark PPPs, and enhancing the transparency of ICP processes. A recap of the global linking procedure was also presented, noting that, for the 2024 benchmark estimates, differences relative to the previous cycle are likely to arise in the context of linking Pacific Island economies and in relation to Eurostat–OECD PPPs estimated using a new classification structure.

During the discussion, it was agreed that there is a need for both internal and external reference to a single, consolidated document describing the methodological steps for PPP computation, including an account of the historical development of ICP methodology.

D3.01 – Status of Consumer Price Index (CPI) - ICP production process integration

ICP Global Office and World Bank presentations

Rui Costa, World Bank, introduced the session on the integration of CPI and ICP surveys and data sources. He recalled that, following a recommendation of the United Nations Statistical Commission to better align ICP activities with national CPI programs, a guide on CPI–ICP integration was published by P. Kelly and P. Rao in 2021. While CPI and ICP serve distinct conceptual purposes, he noted that the benefits of integrating data collection efforts extend beyond cost efficiencies to include strengthened national statistical infrastructure, wider adoption of computerized data processing systems, and improved consistency between ICP results and national inflation measures. A survey conducted among ICP-participating economies in 2017 indicated that, on average, 33 percent of CPI and ICP item baskets overlap, that 40 percent of countries use the same data processing systems for both exercises, and that 64 percent of respondents reported that ICP validation procedures have contributed to improvements in CPI data processing.

Federico Polidoro, World Bank, then presented a review of the current CPI–ICP integration guidelines. He highlighted significant developments since their publication, particularly the increased use of alternative data sources such as transaction and administrative data. It was argued that further integration would benefit from viewing CPI and ICP as multi-technique, multi-source statistical systems rather than as stand-alone surveys. Revisions to the introductory section of the guidelines were recommended, along with expanded treatment of scanner data and web-scraped prices. In addition, it was emphasized that the adoption of COICOP 2018 presents an opportunity to further strengthen CPI–ICP integration, given the high level of correspondence between COICOP 2018 and the ICP classification.

During the discussion, participants highlighted the need for a more intentional and phased implementation approach to CPI–ICP integration, taking into account country-specific constraints and operational challenges. The importance of developing tailored country plans and strengthening collaboration with regional partners was underscored as critical to advancing integration efforts. Participants also stressed the need to clearly articulate the benefits of CPI–ICP integration for countries, including improvements to CPI operations and more effective use of alternative data sources. Finally, the use of concrete case studies was suggested as a means of demonstrating these benefits and encouraging broader adoption of integrated approaches.

Comments from ICP Regional Implementing Agencies

Regional representatives provided feedback on the current use of CPI data within the ICP process, as well as on the guidelines and operational practices followed across regions. Majed Skaini, UN-ESCWA, described regional efforts to strengthen the integration of CPI and ICP item lists and referred to the region's experience with annual PPP production. He noted that countries are encouraged to incorporate items from the regional ICP product list into their CPI baskets when revisions are undertaken, while emphasizing that the extent of CPI–ICP integration varies considerably across countries in the region.

Andrey Kosarev, CIS-STAT, outlined the current state of CPI–ICP integration in the CIS region, presenting evidence on the share of ICP-priced items drawn from CPI lists across participating economies and highlighting substantial heterogeneity in integration practices. He identified differences in product specifications—typically more detailed for ICP than for CPI—as a key challenge.

Kaushal Joshi, Asian Development Bank, discussed the efforts in the region to bring CPI-ICP integration especially with respect to the item lists. He informed that there is a wide range of ICP items common with the CPI item lists among the participating economies. Smaller economies with uniform consumption patterns across the whole economy have a higher percentage of commonality between CPI and ICP items.

The constraints faced by economies in the Asia and Pacific region especially for large economies include differences in market and outlet selection, lack of adequate item specifications in the CPI lists, and presence of multiple subnational indices, which use different subnational item baskets. In this context, he noted that many economies apply their learning from ICP have been adopting ICP type of product specifications for their CPI item basket and incorporating ICP items into the CPI item basket at the time of CPI base year revision exercise. The RIA continues to encourage integration of CPI and ICP item lists, while recognizing the practical limitations faced by national implementing agencies, and caution that the items list for CPI and ICP serve different objectives which should be kept in mind. He also highlighted that CPI-ICP integration is achieved at different operational levels and is not limited to common ICP-CPI items. This includes utilizing same set of staff for price collection of CPI and ICP, establishing synergy in the sampling design to select common markets and outlets, and integrating digital data collection and processing for the two. He also informed that Singapore provides a very good case study which has achieved this integration at various levels.

Rolando Ocampo, UN-ECLAC, reported that four countries in the Latin America and Caribbean region have harmonized CPI and ICP data collection processes to improve efficiency and reduce response burden. He emphasized that further progress in CPI–ICP integration would require increased human resource capacity, with particular attention to Caribbean countries. Grégoire Mboya de Loubassou, African Development Bank, described efforts in the Africa region to advance CPI–ICP integration, including a feasibility survey conducted in ten countries to assess the potential use of harmonized CPI items for ICP data collection. He highlighted the importance of stabilizing a common item list between CPI and ICP and underscored the need for additional resources to support integration efforts.

Hakam Jayyousi, Eurostat, and Sophie Bournot, OECD, referred to the PPP manual and highlighted synergies between PPP and CPI price collection. In Eurostat, strong emphasis is placed on the Harmonised Index of Consumer Prices (HICP), given its standardized framework across member states, with transaction and scanner data presenting further opportunities for CPI–ICP integration. In the OECD, a new metadata questionnaire has been launched to collect information on the overlap between CPI and ICP items, although comprehensive responses from all member countries are still pending.

During the discussion, participants emphasized the importance of striking an appropriate balance between promoting and mandating CPI–ICP integration, focusing on refining existing guidelines and prioritizing direct engagement with individual national statistical offices to support implementation. Improving the comparability of CPI items through more detailed specifications, as required for ICP purposes, was identified as a potential benefit for domestic inflation measurement and a useful incentive for national offices. Participants also noted opportunities to improve efficiency through better synchronization of collection periods, even where item lists differ, and through greater integration of data collection systems. At the same time, it was recognized that limited resources at the regional level constrain the ability of RIAs to engage more intensively with national statistical offices, highlighting the importance of addressing these capacity constraints to make further progress.

D3.02 – Alternative data source utilization

<u>ICP Global Office and World Bank presentations</u>

Federico Polidoro, World Bank, presented the work of the United Nations task team on scanner data, which since its establishment in 2017 has focused on the use of alternative data sources for CPI compilation. The presentation outlined the four main workstreams of the task team—classification, reproducibility, training, and system architecture—and referenced the materials and tools developed under each stream. An overview of the task team's medium-term work plan was also provided, including its intention to extend the use of alternative data sources beyond CPI applications to other statistical domains, such as PPP production.

Rui Costa and Inyoung Song, World Bank, then presented potential opportunities for the use of alternative data sources in PPP estimation at the global level. It was acknowledged that traditional survey data are likely to remain the primary input for global PPP estimates in the near term; however, the growing availability of alternative data sources and advances in data processing techniques suggest that the ICP should actively explore and test their feasibility. At the global level, potential applications of web-scraped data were identified in areas such as industrial equipment, telecommunications, and air travel. In addition, satellite imagery was highlighted as a promising source of auxiliary information for estimating the volume and quality of dwelling units, including indicators such as housing counts, roofing materials, and spatial distribution. It was proposed that a TAG task force be established to advance this agenda, drawing on feedback and contributions from members of the IACG.

During the discussion, participants highlighted challenges associated with acquiring alternative data sources, such as scanner and web-scraped data, noting that data access is often the most difficult step and is highly dependent on country-specific legal and institutional frameworks. Majed Skaini, UN-ESCWA, emphasized the difficulty of extracting internationally comparable items from transaction-based data sources and noted that efforts are under way to classify individual products according to detailed ICP specifications using machine learning and artificial intelligence techniques. By contrast, it was observed that, for ICP purposes, web-scraping approaches—where product specifications are defined ex ante—may offer a more straightforward implementation pathway.

Participants also noted challenges related to processing scanner data alongside traditional survey data, as well as the initial investments required for national statistical offices to integrate alternative data sources into their production systems. It was observed that, even for high-capacity statistical offices, this transition has taken several years, suggesting that transaction-based and survey-based data sources are likely to coexist for the foreseeable future. Finally, reference was made to ongoing experimentation in some regions with the use of satellite imagery for estimating economic outputs or as auxiliary inputs for small area estimation of population and other socio-economic indicators.

Eurostat presentation

Hakam Jayyousi, Eurostat, presented ongoing work in the region related to the use of transaction data—particularly scanner data—for the production of PPPs. Building on initiatives by national statistical offices to integrate alternative data sources into their price statistics programs, Eurostat has established a task force to facilitate information exchange among national statistical offices on this topic. The task force has focused on ensuring comparability across products priced using transaction data, in line with a core principle of PPP compilation.

The task force put forward six recommendations addressing key methodological and operational issues: (i) item selection in line with PPP specifications; (ii) price reporting practices; (iii) weighting of prices; (iv) combining transaction data with traditional survey sources; (v) combining national and capital-city prices; and (vi) ensuring representativity in data selection. Additional recommendations emphasized the need to assess the impact of using transaction data on PPP estimates, noting that empirical evidence remains limited, particularly with respect to issues related to product specifications and the treatment of discounts in transaction data.

The presentation also referred to a recent European Commission regulation that enhances access by national statistical offices to privately held data, providing a strengthened legal basis for expanding the use of transaction data not only for PPP estimation but also for CPI compilation. Finally, it was noted that the number of Eurostat countries using transaction data for parts of their PPP price collection increased from one in 2012 to 16 in 2024.

D3.03 – New and upcoming ICP data processing and production tools

Survey Solutions presentation

Sergiy Radyakin, World Bank, provided an overview of the Survey Solutions platform, highlighting its key features, including support for multiple data collection modes, geographic information system (GIS) data capture, and integration with other systems. He emphasized the platform's versatility and scalability across a wide range of survey operations and demonstrated the Survey Solutions questionnaire designer, which enables users to develop and test questionnaires online. The designer supports multiple question types, validation rules, and the inclusion of multimedia elements.

The presentation also outlined the different user roles within Survey Solutions—administrators, headquarters users, supervisors, and interviewers—and their respective responsibilities in ensuring data quality and efficient survey management. Experience with the implementation of Survey Solutions in Pacific Island economies was discussed, highlighting rapid deployment and positive feedback from participating countries. In this context, the platform is being used for the collection of household consumption prices, with a customizable template available to support country-specific needs. The potential for broader integration of Survey Solutions into ICP data collection was also presented, emphasizing the platform's flexibility and ability to support diverse survey requirements.

During the discussion, representatives from Regional Implementing Agencies reflected on opportunities to promote the use of Survey Solutions among national statistical offices, particularly in smaller countries. Cost considerations were discussed, with emphasis placed on the free availability of the software. Participants also noted the potential to integrate Survey Solutions with existing validation tools, drawing on experiences from the Pacific Community. Finally, it was observed that while Survey Solutions is already widely used across countries for various applications, the main challenge lies in coordinating activities across different programs to achieve efficiencies in the use of human and technical resources.

ICP Global Office presentations

Giovanni Tonutti, World Bank, described the benefits and key features of a programmatic approach to PPP computation and presented the STATA package currently used by the ICP Global Office for the production of global PPPs. He demonstrated the workflow for data retrieval and processing, highlighting the flexibility of the tool and its potential applicability for the computation of regional PPPs.

Maurice Nsabimana, World Bank, presented the ICP PPP Production Platform, originally developed by Eurostat and subsequently adapted for global and regional use within the ICP framework. The platform supports the full PPP production lifecycle, including item list management, data entry, validation, and aggregation of results. Several enhancements have been introduced in response to regional feedback, including bulk data import functionality, data override options, and support for temporal adjustments. The platform is currently deployed and actively used in multiple regions, including Latin America and the Caribbean, Western Asia, and, more recently, the Pacific Islands. It has been customized to meet region-specific requirements, with ongoing technical support provided to ensure effective implementation. Majed Skaini, UN-ESCWA, shared the experience of using the platform in the Western Asia region, highlighting gains in ownership, transparency, and operational efficiency, as well as challenges encountered during the piloting phase and the responsive support provided by the ICP Global Office.

Yuri Dikanhov, World Bank, presented an overview of the ICP calculation tool, an Excel-based application that supports multiple stages of the PPP computation process. The tool is designed to minimize manual intervention, ensure reproducibility of calculations, and generate real-time results following updates to input data. Regional adaptations of the tool were discussed, reflecting specific needs such as gap filling and productivity adjustments. A version of this computation tool is also used for global PPP estimation, operating in parallel with other computational approaches.

Collectively, these tools and enhancements aim to address region-specific requirements while providing increased flexibility, transparency, and consistency in the PPP calculation process across the ICP.

D3.04 – ICP communication and outreach

Maurice Nsabimana, World Bank, presented ongoing efforts to automate the tracking of uses and references to ICP data and PPPs across media, academic publications, and policy outputs. He described the current approach and the limitations of manually monitoring ICP data usage through tools such as Google Scholar, email alerts, and search engines. An experimental approach using generative AI tools, including ChatGPT, was then introduced to support more systematic and scalable tracking. Nsabimana outlined the steps involved in this approach and its potential benefits, and demonstrated sample outputs generated by the AI tool, including structured fields capturing titles, authors, sources, and other metadata. He emphasized that human review remains essential to ensure accuracy and appropriate interpretation of results.

Inyoung Song, World Bank, presented the new ICP global communications and outreach plan, which is structured around five pillars: (i) communications and partner engagement; (ii) knowledge products and training tools; (iii) outreach campaigns and events; (iv) visual identity and user support; and (v) other supporting initiatives. Planned activities include the expansion of ICP visual assets and the development of AI-enabled video guides. A proposal to publish a series of regional blogs was discussed, with each ICP region collaborating with the Global Office to produce a joint blog on the World Bank Data Blog platform. These blogs will highlight regional contexts, showcase data and workshop processes—including data collection and validation—and emphasize collaboration with national statistical offices. Song also demonstrated the use of the Scribe tool to produce concise tutorial videos. In addition, she announced the establishment of a World Bank fellowship in honor of the late economist and ICP contributor Alan Heston, aimed at supporting recent graduates or statisticians working on ICP-related topics. The presentation concluded with an overview of ICP website traffic, noting peaks in usage around the release of global results and the geographic distribution of visitors.

During the discussion, participants emphasized the importance of a strong communication and outreach strategy for the long-term sustainability of the ICP. Leveraging sessions of the United Nations Statistical Commission to raise awareness of the Program was suggested, alongside the importance of cross-posting ICP publications across partner organizations. Representatives from Regional Implementing Agencies also highlighted constraints related to limited resources for communications and outreach activities, both within the ICP and across the broader international statistical community.

D4.01 - Planning for Annual PPP Task Force

<u>ICP Global Office presentation</u>

Marko Rissanen, World Bank, presented the strategic planning framework for the Annual PPP Task Force, outlining its mandate to review and define approaches for annual PPP production, clarify expected outputs, and confirm the proposed membership.

The presentation began with an overview of the evolution of the ICP, highlighting the gradual acceleration in production frequency and the associated benefits of more frequent PPP comparisons, including greater methodological stability and improved operational efficiency. At the same time, a number of persistent challenges were identified, such as inconsistencies between extrapolated and benchmark results, delays in data dissemination, and the need for more timely and coherent PPP outputs. It was noted that while some regions already produce annual PPPs, the current global framework does not fully capitalize on regional interim updates or provide sufficient flexibility for timely revisions. Recent advances in international classifications were also highlighted as offering new opportunities to strengthen coherence and efficiency.

The proposed scope of work for the Task Force includes the development of approaches for annual PPP production at both the regional and global levels, drawing on lessons from previous task forces and existing regional practices. This work will cover the design of alternative data collection models, including rolling and single-year approaches, as well as the establishment of detailed schedules for data submission, validation, and publication.

The Task Force is envisaged to operate over a fixed two-year period, meeting virtually and in person, with support from the ICP Global Implementing Agency. Its main deliverables will include interim and final reports proposing frameworks for annual PPP production, covering data collection strategies, survey timetables, temporal adjustment methods, and recommendations on processing tools. These outputs will be reviewed by the ICP Technical Advisory Group and shared with regional and national agencies to inform implementation planning.

It was emphasized that the Task Force membership should include a balanced mix of technical specialists and representatives from regional and national statistical offices to ensure adequate expertise and broad perspectives. The presentation concluded with an outline of next steps, including the timeline for establishing the Task Force, preparing initial meetings, and delivering preliminary and final outputs.

<u>OECD presentation</u>

Sophie Bournot, OECD, presented the transition from a three-year to an annual calculation of PPPs at the OECD, undertaken to achieve closer alignment with Eurostat's methodology. She recalled that, historically, the OECD and Eurostat differed in their institutional arrangements, data requirements, survey structures, and production timelines. Eurostat operates under a formal regulatory framework supported by EU funding and traditionally collects prices primarily from capital cities, whereas the OECD relies on national price data and applies Eurostat rules without a formal regulatory basis. Differences also existed in survey classifications and frequencies, with the OECD maintaining a three-year cycle for certain surveys, such as equipment goods and construction, compared with Eurostat's two-year cycle.

The transition to annual PPP calculations was described as a gradual process, beginning with initial proposals in 2014 and reaching full implementation from 2016 onward. While the frequency of Gross Fixed Capital Formation surveys was not altered, the move introduced more regular data collection, processing, and publication cycles. At present, the OECD produces PPPs annually, with three reference years updated each December, drawing on rolling survey data and detailed CPI information to annualize and extrapolate prices.

This approach has resulted in more continuous and stable PPP series, facilitating routine data compilation and validation for both countries and the OECD. The presentation concluded by noting that, although some methodological and operational differences between the OECD and Eurostat remain, the shift to annual PPP calculations has strengthened the continuity and reliability of results, increased the relevance of the PPP program for national statistical institutes, and provided more timely outputs for users.

D4.02 - Planning for ICP Classification Update Task Force

<u>ICP Global Office presentation</u>

Inyoung Song, World Bank, presented the strategic planning framework for the ICP Classification Update Task Force, which is mandated to assess and recommend updates to the ICP classification of final expenditure on GDP, ensuring alignment with international statistical standards, in particular the Classification of Individual Consumption According to Purpose (COICOP) 2018 and the forthcoming System of National Accounts (SNA) 2025.

The presentation reviewed the history and evolution of the ICP classification, noting that it is anchored in a common national accounts framework—currently SNA 2008—and is designed to be comparable, representative, and exhaustive in measuring economic activity. The classification underpins PPP comparisons and is aligned with other international frameworks, including Eurostat and OECD PPP classifications. Previous revisions have sought to improve comparability and homogeneity, rationalize the number of basic headings, and preserve comparability across cycles in order to minimize implementation burden for countries and regions.

The COICOP 2018 revision introduces a more granular subclass structure, a systematic distinction between goods and services, and updated categories reflecting changes in consumption patterns. These developments pose challenges for the ICP classification, as not all basic headings can be directly mapped to COICOP subclasses. The presentation illustrated areas of convergence and divergence between ICP and COICOP classifications at different aggregation levels and highlighted the operational implications of merging, splitting, and re-mapping products and headings.

Song emphasized the importance of updating the ICP classification to align with COICOP 2018 and SNA 2025, while limiting disruption to the existing structure and to PPP time series. Although SNA 2025 is not expected to directly alter the ICP classification, it may influence how countries compile GDP expenditure data, with downstream implications for PPP compilation. The Task Force will therefore be required to assess item-level impacts, undertake feasibility analyses, and work closely with stakeholders to update operational materials and supporting software tools.

The Task Force is expected to include experts in index numbers, PPPs, price statistics, national accounts, and international statistical classifications, with representation from ICP agencies as well as independent specialists. It will operate over a two-year period, meeting virtually and in person, and will be supported by the ICP Global Implementing Agency, which will serve as the Task Force secretariat.

IMF presentation

Brian Graf, International Monetary Fund, presented the IMF's work on compiling and maintaining a global CPI database. In the context of the transition to COICOP 2018, he outlined ongoing efforts to monitor country adoption of the new classification. A list of 36 countries that have already implemented COICOP 2018 was presented, with the caveat that this list is not exhaustive. He noted that additional countries are expected to transition in 2026 and 2027, and that further adoptions are likely beyond those currently identified.

Graf highlighted several challenges faced by national statistical offices during the transition, including issues related to the nomenclature of the new divisions, the regrouping of items that were previously classified separately, and the need to link new index series with historical CPI data.

World Bank Intervention

Federico Polidoro, World Bank, discussed ongoing efforts to support national statistical offices in the adoption of COICOP 2018 and identified the availability of official documentation primarily in English as a key constraint affecting implementation in some national contexts. He also noted the need to update household budget surveys in line with COICOP 2018 in order to derive appropriate weights for CPI compilation. More broadly, he emphasized the potential synergies associated with updating CPI and ICP classifications in a coordinated manner.

Eurostat presentation

Hakam Jayyousi, Eurostat, presented Eurostat's plan for implementing the COICOP 2018 classification in coordination with National Accounts (NA), the Harmonised Index of Consumer Prices (HICP), and PPP compilation. National Accounts have introduce COICOP 2018 as part of their benchmark revisions in September 2024, followed by HICP in February 2026, while PPPs will adopt the new classification in December 2025 for the reference years 2022, 2023, and 2024. These changes are underpinned by recent EU regulations that amend the legal frameworks governing NA, HICP, and PPPs.

A new coding system will be introduced to clearly distinguish between legacy and COICOP 2018 basic heading codes by appending the final two digits of the implementation year. All surveys conducted from 2025 onward will apply the new classification, with limited changes affecting specific surveys, including hospital services. Eurostat will recalculate aggregate PPPs for recent reference years using the updated classification, which will require countries to reassign items and, in some cases, apply asterisks to reflect multiple prices within a basic heading.

Spatial and temporal adjustment factors (SAFs and TAFs) will generally be recalculated under the new framework. However, for consumer surveys conducted prior to 2025, existing adjustment factors will be retained at the item level, ensuring that annual national prices remain unchanged.

OECD presentation

Sophie Bournot, OECD, presented the status of implementation of the COICOP 2018 classification across OECD countries. The implementation process comprises several key steps, including the development of a new basic heading list aligned with Eurostat's framework, obtaining country approvals, reallocating items to the new basic headings (with the use of asterisks where multiple prices apply), recalculating existing surveys, collecting CPI and expenditure data under the updated classification, and producing PPPs for new analytical aggregates. The timeline for these activities spans from mid-2024 through December 2025, with recalculations and data collection undertaken in successive phases.

A number of challenges remain, including the recalculation of selected health-related basic headings, incomplete data submissions from some countries, and gaps in CPI and expenditure series under COICOP 2018. At present, only a subset of countries has provided CPI data compiled using the new classification, and expenditure breakdowns remain country-specific, limiting the scope for automated estimation. PPPs for the 2022, 2023, and 2024 reference years are scheduled for production in December 2025, with the 2022 estimates designated as final, the 2023 estimates as semi-final, and the 2024 estimates as preliminary. Consideration is being given to the recalculation of historical series; however, this may be deferred until 2026, subject to preferences expressed by Eurostat countries.

Conclusions

The ICP Classification Update Task Force is expected to deliver an updated ICP classification, an interim approach applicable to the ICP 2024 cycle, methodological assessments, and final recommendations. The proposed timeline begins with the finalization of Task Force membership and the convening of the first meeting in early 2026, followed by the development of operational materials and supporting research throughout 2026. The updated classification and accompanying documentation are scheduled for delivery in 2027, while new operational materials, guidelines, and reports are expected to be available by the end of the third quarter of 2026 to support preparations for the ICP 2027 cycle.

Key next steps include the nomination of Task Force members, the preparation of detailed proposals, and the identification of operational materials and tools requiring updates, with a strong emphasis on supporting countries and regions during the transition. The ICP Global Office will continue bilateral engagement with Regional Implementing Agencies to coordinate classification updates, identify operational requirements, and ensure that region-specific perspectives are reflected in the revised tools and materials.

D5.01 - ICP Data Access Policy

Mizuki Yamanaka, World Bank, presented the evolution and proposed future direction of the ICP data access procedure.

The ICP data access policy was first developed during the 2005 cycle in response to increasing demand from users for more detailed data. It was subsequently revised for the 2011 cycle to reflect growing expectations around government transparency and accountability, in line with the broader open data movement. Decisions taken by the ICP Governing Board in 2016 and 2017 further formalized the current Data Access and Archiving Policy. The overarching objective of the policy is to maximize the use of ICP data for statistical, research, and analytical purposes while safeguarding confidentiality.

Under the current framework, access to non-public ICP data requires the submission of a signed Confidentiality Statement by a senior official and a detailed Research Proposal. Proposals are required to specify the data requested, research context, JEL classification codes, research objectives and methodology, relevant literature, intended use, expected outputs, dissemination plans, and anticipated benefits to the ICP. Applicants must also provide their curriculum vitae and unique user account identifiers. The ICP Global Office reviews submissions and may request clarifications to confirm the necessity of unpublished data and ensure appropriate protection of confidential information.

Looking ahead, the ICP is considering a transition toward a more structured and dynamic data access framework that emphasizes the value and impact of ICP datasets. Proposed enhancements include the introduction of periodic, biannual “research windows” aligned with the regular production of ICP results. These windows would streamline access, involve technical experts more systematically in the review process, and better align approved research with global, regional, and national priorities. The proposal also envisages clearer selection criteria and more transparent communication of outcomes. By encouraging high-quality proposals and supporting innovative research, the revised framework aims to increase the visibility and analytical impact of ICP data.

The meeting concluded that further consultation is required to refine the proposed reforms and develop detailed operational guidelines for the enhanced data access procedure. The objective is to implement changes that promote high-value research aligned with the strategic priorities of the ICP, while continuing to address participating countries’ concerns regarding data confidentiality.

D5.02 - Planning for 2025/26 governance and coordination events and activities

This section summarizes governance and coordination events and activities discussed during the meeting, drawing on contributions from all participants.

The 57th Session of the United Nations Statistical Commission (UNSC) is scheduled for March 3–6, 2026. The World Bank will submit its official report to the Commission, outlining the status of ICP implementation, key achievements, and ongoing challenges. Regional Implementing Agencies are expected to provide regional inputs by October 31 to inform the preparation of the report. The first meeting of the newly constituted ICP Governing Board is intended to be strategically aligned with the UNSC session, and agreement was reached on holding this meeting in conjunction with the Commission. To facilitate timely arrangements, the nomination process for new Governing Board members is expected to be completed by late 2025.

The Technical Advisory Group is scheduled to convene virtually in January 2026 to review global updates, establish the new ICP research agenda, provide feedback on research topics emerging from previous ICP cycles, consider potential membership changes, and address other business. Two task forces are being launched: the Task Force on Annual PPP Production and the Task Force on ICP Classification Update. In light of the urgency of the work, it was agreed that the ICP Classification Update Task Force will commence activities through virtual engagement in the first quarter of 2026, with the Annual PPP Production Task Force also expected to begin its work in early 2026.

The next meeting of the IACG is planned for the second quarter of 2026 and will focus on the first round of global validation for ICP 2024 cycle data. Regional Implementing Agencies are expected to submit regional datasets to the Global Office on a rolling quarterly basis throughout 2026.

D5.03 - Summary of the meeting and closing remarks

Talip Kilic, World Bank, expressed appreciation for the sustained commitment of participants, noting that many have been engaged with the ICP over much of their professional careers. He highlighted the strong engagement observed both in person and virtual participation and underscored the importance of collective efforts in advancing the program. Participants emphasized that countries are central to the success of the ICP, often operating under significant resource and staffing constraints, including during periods such as the COVID-19 pandemic, and stressed the need to remain attentive to country-level challenges.

The IACG underscored the importance of positioning the ICP as a strategic priority for countries, supported by more deliberate communication and advocacy. Leveraging platforms such as the UNSC and other high-level engagements was suggested to raise the profile of the program. Resource mobilization was identified as an immediate priority, with planned outreach to investment banks, regional development banks, bilateral donors, and potentially the private sector. Appreciation was also expressed for the support of Haishan Fu and ongoing funding efforts.

Participants highlighted the value of collaborative exchanges and the sharing of regional experiences, emphasizing the role of in-person meetings in facilitating effective discussion. The ICP team and meeting organizers were thanked for their efforts, and continued outreach and future in-person engagements, including ICP presentations at upcoming forums, were encouraged to further strengthen the program’s visibility and impact.

Annex 1: Meeting Agenda

DAY 1: MONDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2025	
09:00 – 09:30	**Welcome and opening remarks**
09:30 – 10:00	**D1.00 - Introduction of the Development Economics Data Group Survey Unit**
10:00 – 12:30	**D1.01 - Global updates**
14:00 – 17:00	**D1.02 - Regional updates: ICP 2024 cycle implementation**
DAY 2: TUESDAY, OCTOBER 21, 2025	
09:00 – 11:45	**D2.01 - Regional validation findings and recommendations**
11:45 – 12:30	**D2.02 - Reference PPP mapping**
14:00 – 14:45	**D2.03 - Item mapping**
14:45 – 15:30	**D2.04 - PPP aggregation mapping**
15:45 – 16:30	**D2.05 - Review of survey, metadata, and submission forms**
16:30 – 17:00	**D2.06 - Increasing transparency of global PPP calculation procedures**
DAY 3: WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 22, 2025	
09:00 – 10:00	**D3.01 - Status of Consumer Price Index (CPI) - ICP production process integration**
10:00 – 11:00	**D3.02 - Alternative data source utilization**

11:15 – 15:30 D3.03 - New and upcoming ICP data processing and production tools

15:45 – 17:00 D3.04 - ICP communication and outreach

DAY 4: THURSDAY, OCTOBER 23, 2025

09:00 – 12:30 D4.01 - Planning for Annual PPP Task Force

14:00 – 17:00 D4.02 - Planning for ICP Classification Update Task Force

DAY 5: FRIDAY, OCTOBER 24, 2025

09:00 – 10:00 D5.01 - ICP data access procedure

10:15 – 14:30 D5.02 - Planning for 2025/26 governance and coordination events and activities

14:30 – 15:00 D5.03 - Summary of the meeting and closing remarks

Annex 2: List of participants

African Development Bank (AfDB)

- Gregoire Mboya de Loubassou (by videoconference)

Asian Development Bank (ADB)

- Kaushal Joshi (in-person)

Interstate Statistical Committee of the Commonwealth of Independent States (CIS-STAT)

- Andrey Kosarev (by videoconference)
- Valerica Accibas (by videoconference)

Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development (OECD)

- Sophie Bournot (in-person)

Statistical Office of the European Communities (Eurostat)

- Hakam Jayyousi (in-person)

United Nations Economic Commission for Latin America and the Caribbean (UN-ECLAC)

- Rolando Ocampo (in-person)
- Alfonso Zeron (by videoconference)
- Ernestina Perez (by videoconference)
- Giannina Lopez (by videoconference)
- Lady Infante (by videoconference)
- Maria Alejandra Ovalle (by videoconference)

United Nations Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia (UN-ESCWA)

- Majed Skaini (in-person)
- Gaelle Abi Chedid (by videoconference)

International Monetary Fund (IMF)

- Brian Graf (by videoconference)

World Bank

- Haishan Fu (in-person)
- Talip Kilic (by videoconference)
- Marko Rissanen (in-person)

- Giovanni Tonutti (in-person)
- Inyoung Song (in-person)
- Maurice Nsabimana (in-person)
- Mizuki Yamanaka (in-person)
- Rui Costa (in-person)
- Tigist Shibru (in-person)
- Wei Zhang (in-person)
- Yan Bai (in-person)
- Yuri Dikhanov (in-person)
- Sergey Radyakin (in-person)
- Karenina Velandia (in-person)
- Federico Polidoro (by video conference)